Absorption and storage

- Absorption occurs in intestine. Being fat-soluble, its absorption is enhanced by sufficient amount of bile salts. mainly in the jejunum by the way of lymphatus. Liver stores appreciable amounts of vitamin K.

Deficiency:

- Deficiency of vitamin K is very rare, as most of the daily foods contain this vitamin. In addition, intestinal flora of micro organisms synthesize adequate quantity of vitamin K.
- The deficiency of vitamin K leads to a lowering of prothrombin level and increased clotting time of blood. This may lead to hemorrhagic conditions (Figure. 8.11).



Figure 8.11 Hemorrhagic condition

8.2 Water soluble vitamins:

The members of this group are B-complex vitamins and vitamin C . They are readily soluble in water and can be transported freely in the blood and the watery fluids between the cells. However, vitamin B_{12} needs a binding protein for the transport. Excess of these vitamins are eliminated via kidneys. Unlike other members of this family the vitamin B_{12} is eliminated through bile. As these are readily soluble in water these vitamins are easily lost during cooking.

8.2.1 B-complex vitamins

The vitamin B has a group of vitamins (B_1, B_2, B_3, B_5, B_6, B_{12}, biotin and folate). All these vitamins needs to be converted into the corresponding coenzymes which is their active form. They are useful in the synthesis of many neurotransmitters such as acetylcholine.

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